Grand Rounds · October 2026

SIGN-OUT

Question 22

Ulcerative colitis & PSC

BLOCK	QUESTION	VIDEO
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What you need to know before moving on.

Question 22

A 26-year-old man comes to the physician because of a 4-month history of bloody diarrhea with mucus. He has 6 to 8 small-volume bowel movements daily, often with urgency and a sensation of incomplete evacuation, and he wakes at night to defecate. He has lost 4 kg (8.8 lb) during this period. Over the past month, he has also had intermittent redness and aching of his right eye. He has not traveled recently and has not taken antibiotics.

Temperature is 37.8°C (100°F), pulse is 92/min, and blood pressure is 116/72 mm Hg. The abdomen is soft with mild tenderness in the left lower quadrant. There are no perianal skin tags or fistulas. Rectal examination shows bright red blood mixed with stool.

Hemoglobin	**10.8 g/dL**
Erythrocyte sedimentation rate	**48 mm/h**
Stool culture	**negative**
Stool ova and parasites	**negative**
Clostridioides difficile toxin	**negative**

A barium enema is shown. Biopsy specimens obtained at subsequent colonoscopy show crypt abscesses and distorted crypt architecture without granulomas.



This patient is at greatest risk for which of the following conditions?

A Calcium oxalate nephrolithiasis

B Enterovesical fistula

C Megaloblastic anemia from vitamin B12 malabsorption

D Primary sclerosing cholangitis

E Strictures of the terminal ileum

ANSWER AND VIDEO ON THE NEXT PAGE

QUESTION 22 · ULCERATIVE COLITIS & PSC

Answer D.

Primary sclerosing cholangitis

THE CLASS

58%

got it right (7 of 12)

MOST CHOSEN WRONG

C

2 of 12 · Megaloblastic anemia from vitamin B12 malabsorption

Watch the explanation

Opens the video in your browser.